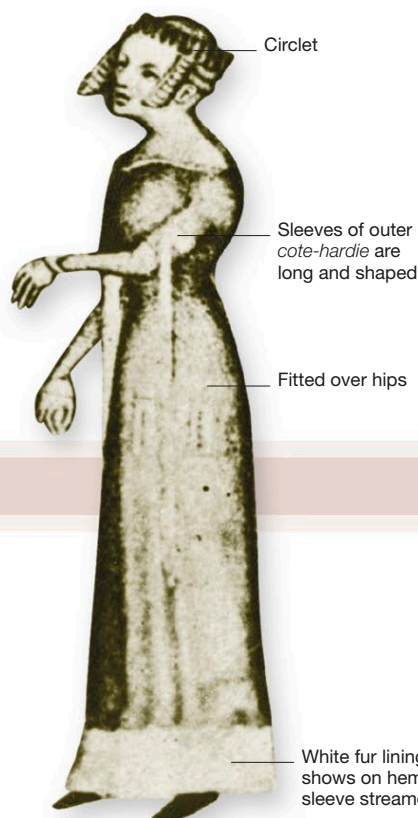
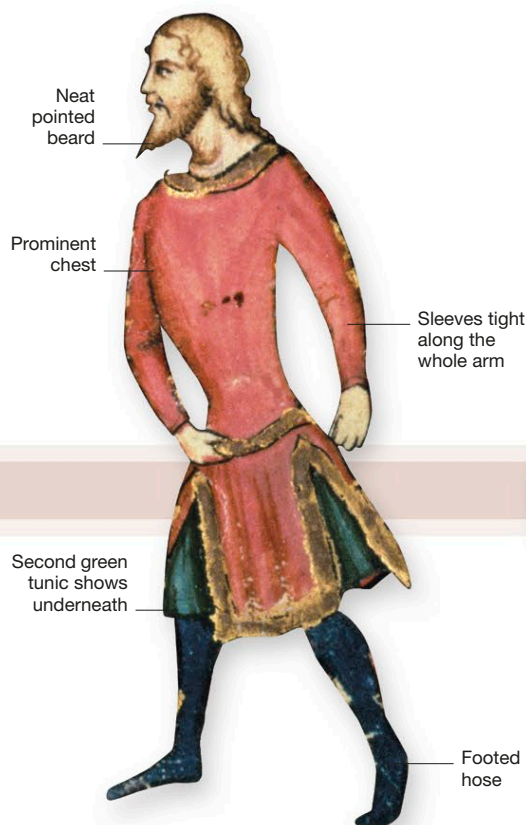
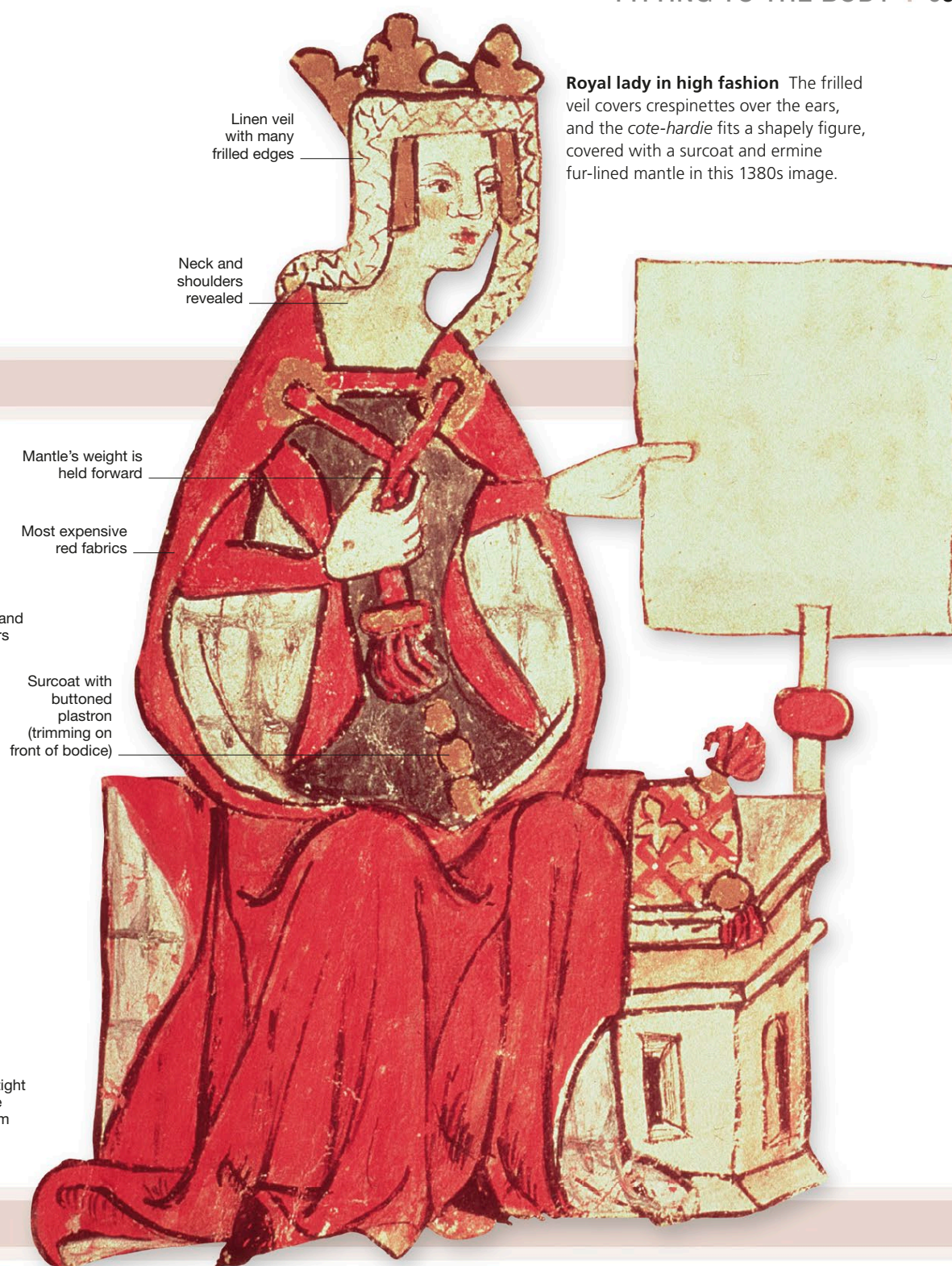




Perfect fit This lady's 1370 *cote-hardie* (outer tunic) cleaves exactly to her upper body. The high, round chest was also favoured in men's fashion. The wide, boat neckline shows off her shoulders, and her plaited-back hair is brought forward in loops over her ears.



Getting slimmer A 1350s Neapolitan illumination shows how the amount of fabric used in tunics was reduced as fit improved. This man still has a fuller skirt, slit over each thigh. His hose are made of wool fabric cut on the bias (diagonally) to stretch around the leg.



Royal lady in high fashion The frilled veil covers crespinettes over the ears, and the *cote-hardie* fits a shapely figure, covered with a surcoat and ermine fur-lined mantle in this 1380s image.

LEATHER SHOES

Medieval leather shoes survive in much greater numbers than fragile textiles. These London examples show some of the styles. Piercing or incising with decorative patterns was popular and showed off coloured hose underneath. The long "poulaine" toe was stuffed with whalebone, wool, or moss to keep the shape. Noblemen's shoes were embroidered with silks. It was hard to keep feet dry, so people wore pattens – overshoes with raised wooden soles that kept feet above the mud and ordure as they walked.

Fenestrated leather shoe



Poulaine shoe with leaf motif



Poulaine shoe

